

When I entered the classroom for the first time, I was not sure what to expect. It was my first time being on an actual publication, and I would be lying if I said that I was not nervous. However, over the course of this semester, this class has taught me more skills than many of my other classes.

With the responsibility of writing articles that are read by actual people, I had to learn how to come up with good topics to write about, reach out to all kinds of people to set up interviews, ask for ads and sponsorships, and collaborate with my classmates to design pages among other things. This class made me step out of my comfort zone and forced me to grow as a person as a member of a formal publication.

Needless to say, this growth did not happen without challenges. I was a bit shocked at how mundane Palo Alto seemed to be at times in the effort to find interesting topics, and interviews were sometimes hard to schedule even with the plethora of people that I reached out to. As a student athlete, I already had limited time within my schedule and I had to carefully manage my time usage as conducting research and reporting often left little opportunity for other schoolwork. What seemed familiar just a few short months ago now appeared confusing as I had to navigate the specific InDesign requirements, and I am grateful for all of the different people that were willing to help me out. I remember Gavin helping me fix the text wrap in less than a minute after me and Johnny were struggling for 10.

What surprised me the most about high school journalism were the people that I met. I mostly stuck to my grade level except for my swim team, but this was the first class where I was with people from all sorts of grade levels. As I was one of the younger ones in the class, I was surprised at how welcoming everybody was and their willingness to help me out. I could tell that they actually cared, and I am excited to work with the ones that are not graduating next year. I also got to meet all kinds of people including nonprofit owners, city council representatives, and school board members along with countless others as I reported on these stories, and I have learned a lot about my community.

These skills and experiences have translated to other areas of my life as well. In addition to the obvious usage of my article-writing skills in English class and other classes where I have to write paragraphs or essays, I have used other technical skills as well. I use Photoshop and other editing tools when I record my Minecraft gameplay or other videos. I also use the photo-taking skills that I learned in journalism in everyday life, especially when I take pictures of my cat. In addition, the consistent collaboration with others for stories and production has made me better at working with others.

It has only been a semester, but I have had an amazing experience so far and I am excited to contribute to the Campanile in the future.